



Presented by The High End

CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

Full-Size Walk-In House with Door, Windows & Roof

Build a full-size cardboard house they can actually walk into. Move-in ready.

AGES	BOXES	TIME	DIFF	PIECES
3-8	4-6 Wardrobe/Appliance Boxes	2-3 Hours	Intermediate **	4 pcs

CARDBOARD NEEDED:

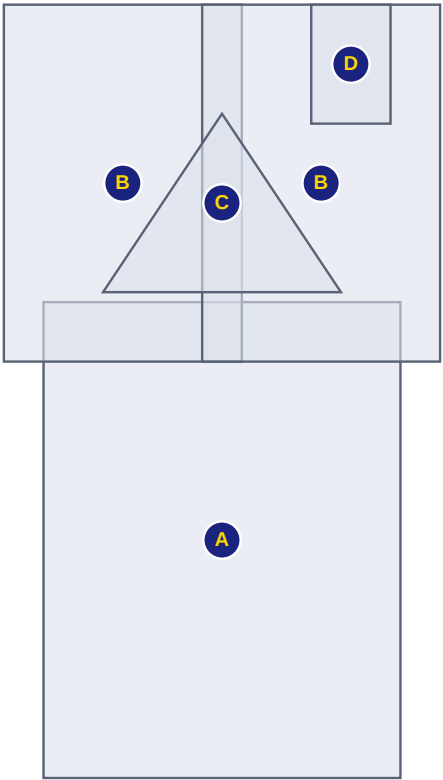
4-6 Wardrobe/Appliance Boxes (at least 36" x 48" (91 x 122 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:

Build a full-size walk-in playhouse: 4 walls, working door, 2 windows, peaked roof, chimney.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

The finished build, front view, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.



EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD				
A	WALL PANEL 36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm)	CUT ×4	B	ROOF PANEL 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) CUT ×2
C	GABLE TRIANGLE 24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm) CUT ×2		D	CHIMNEY PANEL 8" × 12" (20 × 30 cm) CUT ×4

BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

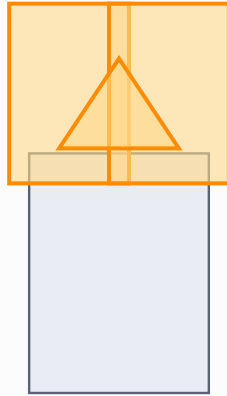
2

BUILD 4 WALLS



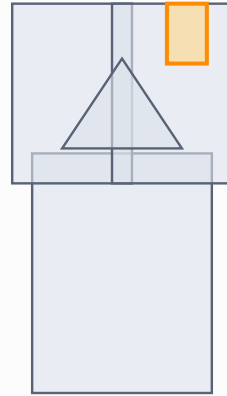
5

ADD GABLE ENDS



7

BUILD THE CHIMNEY

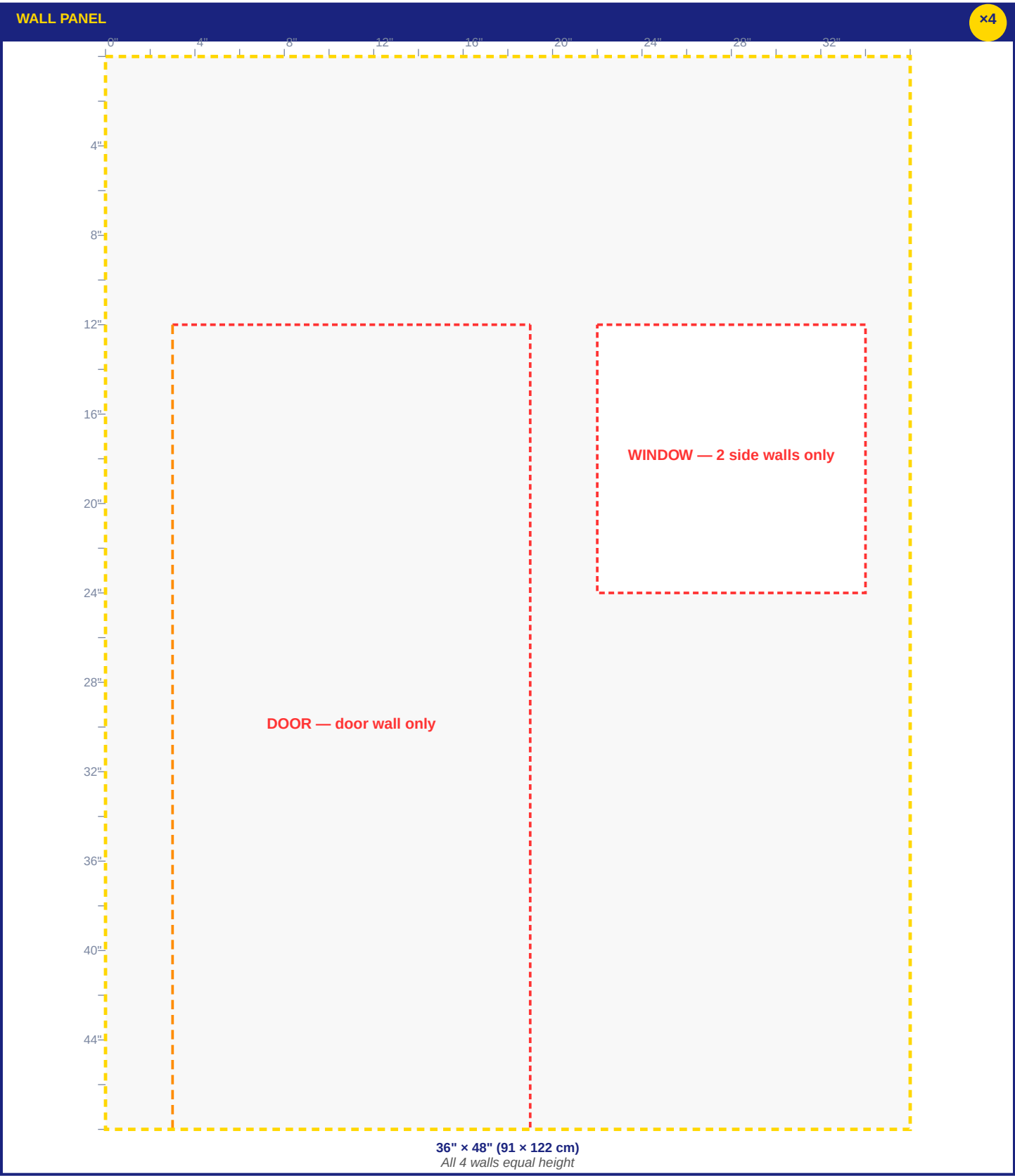




WALL PANEL

36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

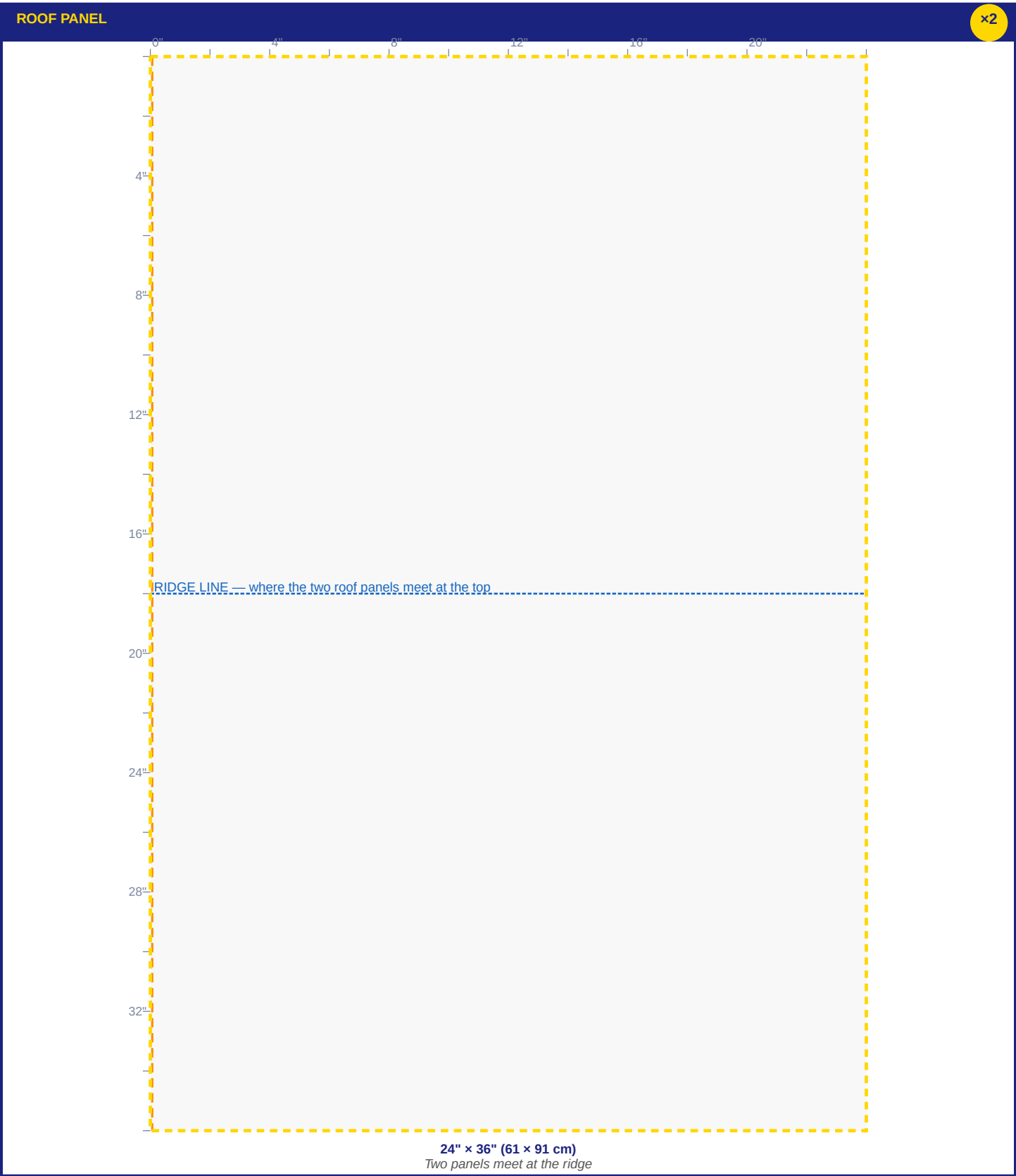
NOTE: All 4 walls equal height



ROOF PANEL

24" x 36" (61 x 91 cm) | Cut x2

CUT
x2



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line	SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through
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NOTE: Two panels meet at the ridge



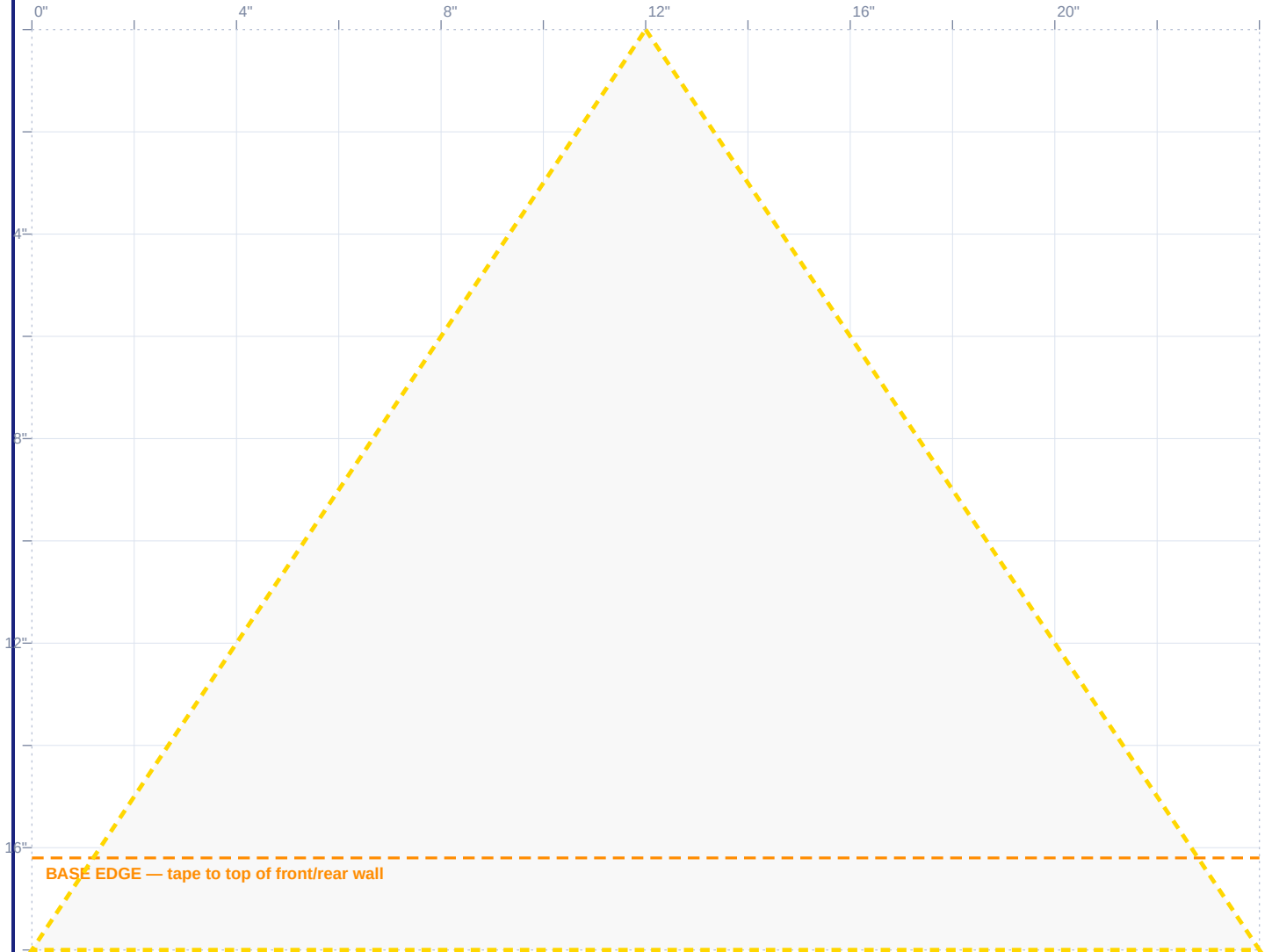
GABLE TRIANGLE

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

GABLE TRIANGLE

x2



HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark the centre of the top edge. Draw straight lines from there to both bottom corners.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm)

Triangle — straight bottom, two sides angling to a centre peak

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

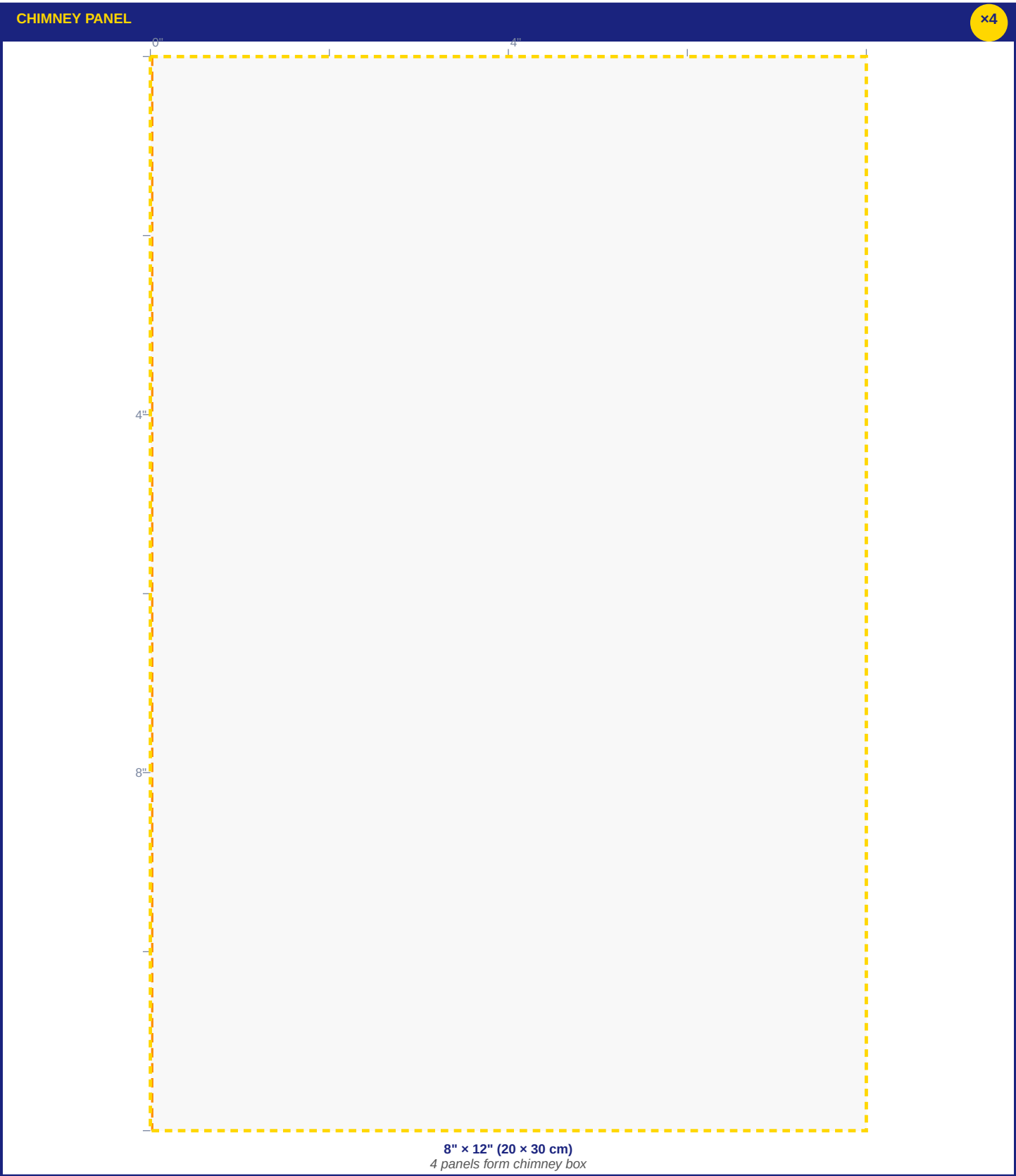
NOTE: Fills gap between wall top and roof peak



CHIMNEY PANEL

8" x 12" (20 x 30 cm) | Cut x4

CUT
x4



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: 4 panels form chimney box

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

CARDBOARD PIECES — 4 TOTAL (4–6 Wardrobe/Appliance Boxes (at least 36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm) each))

×4

Wall Panel

36" × 48"

All 4 walls equal height

×2

Roof Panel

24" × 36"

Two panels meet at the ridge

×2

Gable Triangle

24" × 18"

Fills gap between wall top and roof peak

×4

Chimney Panel

8" × 12"

4 panels form chimney box

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 4–6 large cardboard boxes (appliance size)

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape (3+ rolls)

+ Paint or markers in child's favorite colors

+ Extra cardboard for door handle, window frames

+ Ruler + pencil

FUN FACT!

The smallest house ever lived in full-time was 8 feet wide. Your cardboard house might be bigger.

CHALLENGE!

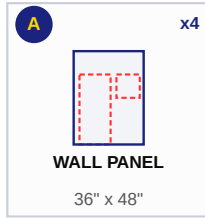
Housewarming party! Once built, set a table inside, invite stuffed animals, have a snack. What's the most people you can fit?

1

STEP 1: FLATTEN & PLAN

Flatten all boxes. Lay all 4 Wall Panels on the floor. Mark which wall gets the door and which 2 get windows BEFORE cutting anything.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

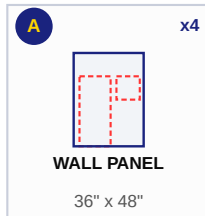
STEP 2: BUILD 4 WALLS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Stand the 4 Wall Panels upright and tape all 4 corners — 3+ layers inside AND outside. House must be square. Measure the two diagonals — they must be equal. Adjust corners before tape dries.

SAFETY: Two people needed to hold walls while taping each corner.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



3

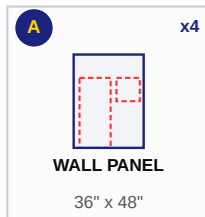
STEP 3: CUT THE DOOR

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

On the door wall only: the door is 16" (41 cm) wide × 36" (91 cm) tall and starts at the floor, so there is nothing to trip over. Cut its top edge and its right side along the red dashes. Do NOT cut the orange left side — score it and fold the door open on it. Add a cardboard handle tab on the right side.

SAFETY: Adult cuts only. Smooth the cut edges — no sharp corners at child height.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



4

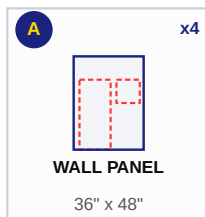
STEP 4: CUT THE WINDOWS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

On the 2 side walls only: cut out a 12" × 12" (30 × 30 cm) window where the template shows, 12" (30 cm) down from the top edge. Add cardboard cross-strips through each window.

SAFETY: Adult cuts all window openings.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

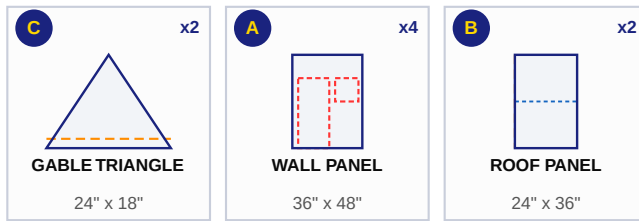


5

STEP 5: ADD GABLE ENDS

Cut both Gable Triangles (taper marks on template). These fill the triangular gap between the top of the front/rear walls and the roof peak. Tape to front and rear wall tops.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



6

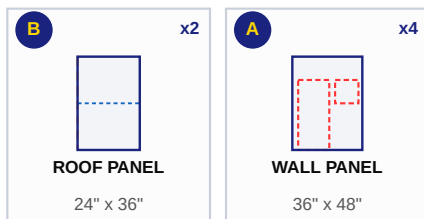
STEP 6: ADD THE ROOF

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Lay both Roof Panels across the top — one on each side, meeting at the center ridge (score line on template marks the ridge). Tape the ridge seam from the inside. Tape roof panels to the tops of all 4 walls.

SAFETY: Two people needed — one holds roof panels, one tapes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

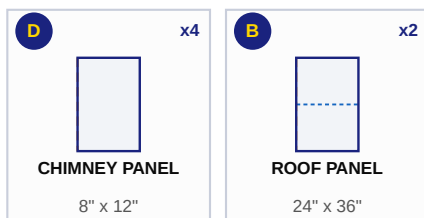


7

STEP 7: BUILD THE CHIMNEY

Tape all 4 Chimney Panels into a rectangular tube (fold marks on template show attachment edges). Mount off-center on the roof. Tape through the roof into the chimney sides.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



8

STEP 8: DECORATE

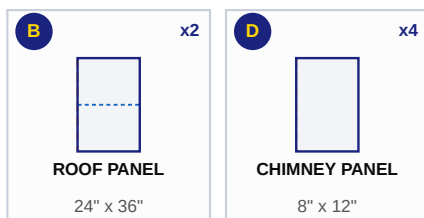
Paint the child's favorite colors. Draw brick lines. Add flower boxes under windows. Paint a name on the door. Draw a welcome mat at the entrance.

9

STEP 9: QUALITY CHECK

Child walks through the door (taller kids duck a little). Windows visible. Roof fully covered. Chimney upright. House stands without being held. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations